

1. INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 LG Living Ltd (LGL) has prepared this document to support your fee proposal for the redevelopment of 83 New Kent Rd (the site), within the London Borough of Southwark.
- 1.2 The document summarises the existing site, the proposed scheme, as well as the technical due diligence conducted to date.
- 1.3 A high level programme is appended to this document.
- 1.4 You are expecting to provide a fee proposal from RIBA Stage 2 – 5.

2. THE EXISTING BUILDING

- 2.1 The property was constructed in circa. 1905. The building as converted in 1989 into its current form.
- 2.2 The property is currently student accommodation consisting of 85 standard rooms that are arranged in clusters of two to six rooms, with each cluster sharing bathroom and kitchen facilities. The building has been vacant since March 2020. There is no planning consents available from Southwark Council.
- 2.3 The buildings are not Statutorily Listed buildings on the Historic England register nor is the site designated as within a Conservation Area. However, according to the recently adopted London Borough of Southwark (LBS) Local List (Dec 2023), the building is classed as a Locally Listed Building.
- 2.4 The site comprises three purpose-built interconnected buildings (use class Sui Generis) of between 2 and 4 stores in height, with a central courtyard area, totalling 26,615 sq ft (2,473 sq m) GIA.
- 2.5 The small courtyard fronting New Kent Road contains trees protected by Tree Preservation Orders (TPOs), which must be retained.

3. PROPOSED SCHEME

- 3.1 The existing building will be reconfigured to optimise space and functionality through:
 - (a) Delivering 93 ensuite studio units, averaging 17 sq m. The majority of these units will have mezzanines, adding an additional 3.75 sq m of useable space per unit. This increases the average usable space to 19.2 sq m per unit.
 - (b) Introduction of two new lifts, both meeting fire evacuation standards.
 - (c) Introduction of Air Source Heat Pumps.
 - (d) Providing shared amenity space totalling 91 sq m.
 - (e) Targeting EPC B.
 - (f) A high-spec fit-out to help differentiate the product.

4. STRUCTURAL DESIGN

- 4.1 Frame Engineers conducted a non-intrusive visual inspection on the 15th January 2025, which concludes the following:
- (a) *“Following a review of all available record information and Frame Engineers’ site walkover, the general condition of the structure appears reasonable with no significant signs of structural defects. Therefore, it is not currently expected that excessive structural repairs will be required as part of the refurbishment.”*
- 4.2 The typical existing structure of the blocks with mansard roofs are expected to consist of one way spanning concrete slabs supported off a series of downstand beams which are themselves supported off load-bearing solid masonry walls. There is a possibility the structural floor buildups may be of another construction methodology such as clay-pot floors or similar. This will be confirmed as part of the soft-strip and intrusive survey works.
- 4.3 The two smaller blocks with pitched roofs are expected to have timber joist floors which are supported off the external masonry load-bearing walls.
- 4.4 The condition of the structure was observed to be reasonable with no significant signs of degradation or defects. A more detailed visual inspection will be required following soft strip to verify this.

5. MEP DESIGN

- 5.1 Scotch and Partners issued a report on 31 January 2025, a summary of which is as follows:
- (a) *“The report outlines the recommended MEP interventions to uplift the existing EPC for the site from EPC E to EPC B. This is mainly achieved via replaced of current heating and domestic hot water system with air source heat pumps and fabric upgrades to the development. Outline plant areas have been given for these interventions and a high level review of existing utility infrastructure and maintenance report (by Fulkers Bailey Russell) indicates that the high level cost plan allow for power and water upgrades.”*
- 5.2 The key considerations regarding MEP are provided below.
- 5.3 A substantial improvement to EPC will require an all-electric system and likely require replacing the existing gas boiler system with Air Source Heat Pumps (ASHPs) for heating and domestic hot water. The preferred approach is to install ASHPs on the roof of each block, subject to further feasibility reviews.
- 5.4 New high-performance double pane windows are a required. Depending on the outcome of future studies, building fabric upgrades may also be needed. As the building is not be a new build residential building, it will not need to comply with Part O – overheating in dwellings.
- 5.5 The preventative maintenance report provided by Fulkers Bailey Russel recommends that the main incoming power supply be upgraded, as it has reached the end of its serviceable life. It is recommended that this be replaced with a new system.
- 5.6 The capacity of the incoming electrical infrastructure is not fully determined, but given the planned MEP interventions, including replacing gas boiler installations with ASHPs, the power load is expected to increase. A full assessment should be undertaken to determine the extent of necessary upgrades, including allowances in the cost plan for increasing electrical capacity.

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- 5.7 Domestic hot water will be supplied through a decentralised system with dedicated pump rooms and calorifiers for each block. The precise sizing and layout will need further coordination with the architectural team.
 - 5.8 A central cold water storage tank and pump set are being considered, but additional flow and pressure tests are required to confirm strategy.
 - 5.9 A sprinkler system will be installed, requiring a dedicated storage tank and pump system. The placement and specifications will be determined in the next design stage.
 - 5.10 Additional drainage surveys are needed to confirm existing connections and assess the best approach for integrating new plumbing stacks.

Next Steps

- 5.11 Conduct a detailed energy model to validate the EPC upgrade strategy and refine ASHP requirements.
- 5.12 Undertake a full acoustic assessment for ASHP locations to mitigate potential noise impacts.
- 5.13 Conduct flow and pressure tests for incoming water supply and assess capacity for cold water storage.
- 5.14 Carry out a CCTV survey of existing below-ground drainage infrastructure to determine capacity and potential modifications.
- 5.15 Develop a coordinated MEP plan to confirm spatial requirements for plant rooms, risers, and service routes.
- 5.16 Confirm structural feasibility for rooftop plant loads and ensure appropriate waterproofing measures are in place.
- 5.17 Assess structural implications for rooftop plant installations, including loading and waterproofing considerations.
- 5.18 Define emergency generator backup requirements for lifts.

6. UTILITIES

- 6.1 There are a significant number of different utilities running beneath the courtyard area and beneath the existing building at the site.
- 6.2 To redirect these would come at a significant cost. It is therefore proposed that no basement excavation will be carried out at the site.
- 6.3 The property includes a substation chamber leased to London Power Networks PLC since 1991. It is located on the ground floor and highlighted on the lease plan.

7. FIRE

- 7.1 Sprinklers will be required throughout the building to safeguard the residential nature of the scheme over 11 metres in height as per the expectations of contemporary guidance.
- 7.2 The proposed lifts will function as full evacuation lifts, equipped with backup power to support emergency operations.

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- 7.3 Dry risers may be designated for each stair core to enhance hose coverage.
 - 7.4 The high-level development strategy has been reviewed in accordance with contemporary guidance, whilst sympathetic to the existing nature of the scheme and approved by Ben Green of Semper and adequate cost allowance has been made for fire-works.

8. ASBESTOS

- 8.1 A detailed asbestos survey was conducted in 2014 by Phil Brown of eSafe Consultancy Limited. This management audit and re-inspection confirmed that no asbestos risks were detected in the areas surveyed.
- 8.2 Areas not accessed during the survey or concealed behind newer materials may still contain asbestos, however Phil Brown provided verbal input that this is unlikely.

Next Steps

- 8.3 An intrusive asbestos survey must be completed before any refurbishment or demolition work. The next steps include commissioning the survey, ensuring compliance with the Control of Asbestos Regulations, and using the findings to guide safe operations or redevelopment.

9. APPENDIX

- 9.1 Planning Note
- 9.2 Programme (subject to change)
- 9.3 Sales Brochure

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